

▲ Fig 5 Solar cooker

is covered by one or more transparent covers, the purpose of which is to trap the heat inside the solar cooker. The temperature maintained is around 140°C. Cost of the cooker and the maintenance cost is low. It takes longer time and special vessels need to be used

Merits:

1. Simple techniques – requires no special skill.
2. Cost effective as natural sunlight is the form of energy
3. Original flavour of food is retained
4. There is no danger of scorching or burning
5. Loss of nutrients is minimum as only little amount of water is used in cooking

Demerits:

1. Special equipment is needed
2. Slow cooking process
3. Cannot be used in the absence of sunlight-rainy season, late evening and night

Activity 4

Observe and list the changes in the colour, texture and taste of the following food items after they are cooked. Also note the method used for cooking them.

- Spinach
- Rice
- Toor dhal
- Potato
- Egg

3.6 STEPS IN MINIMIZING LOSS OF NUTRIENTS DURING COOKING

Some nutrients are lost when foods are cooked. Nutrients like vitamin B and C are lost when foods are boiled or soaked in water and the water is thrown away. Nutrients like vitamin A are lost when fats are used for cooking foods. Therefore we must think of ways of saving these nutrients.

- Wash vegetables before cutting them so that minerals and vitamins are not destroyed. Do not wash the foods more than necessary.
- Peel vegetables thinly as vitamins and minerals are found just under the skin.
- Cut vegetables into large pieces just before cooking. Small pieces mean greater loss of nutrients.
- If vegetables are to be cooked in water, put them into boiling water. Scrape the peels very thin.
- Use just enough water for cooking. Do not throw away the extra water. Use this

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